D 141 | Perceptions are not demand

PRIVATE FICTIONAL workflow-tool lab. Rupees per firm per month, exclusive of tax; no tax calculated. No GST filing service, customer interview or price change.

Package economics	A: 100 offers, 20 buyers, price 1000, cost 300, acquisition 6000 gives revenue 20000, contribution after acquisition 8000. B: 100 offers, 15 buyers, price 1400, cost 400, acquisition 6000 gives 21000 and 9000. Price and service cost both differ: package result, not isolated elasticity.
Free is not costless	1000 free accounts cost 20 each; 100 paid contribute 300 each after paid variable costs; fixed 5000. Net 5000. Break-even paid accounts 83.333333, so 84 whole accounts; maximum free accounts 1250. Separate toy, not derived from either package or proven conversion.
Four distinct perceptions	Six entirely fictional threshold rows: too cheap, bargain, expensive but considered, too expensive. These are not real respondents. Three acceptable/expensive/prohibitive interview thresholds do not complete four-question PSM.
Declared counting rule	At each grid price p, too-cheap and bargain shares count thresholds strictly ABOVE p; expensive and too-expensive count AT OR BELOW p. All six equal weight. Boundary convention explicit; no smooth interpolation, intersection estimate, revenue curve or financial optimum.
Do not repair invented data	Raw four thresholds remain visible. This teaching implementation blocks all curves on any nonnumeric, negative or out-of-order row, or invalid price grid. Equal adjacent thresholds allowed. This is a diagnostic policy, not the only defensible cleaning rule; never silently sort, impute or drop real replies.
Approval remains blank	Plan unit, period, tax framing, eligible buyers, comprehension, consent, sampling, alternatives, behavioral validation and stop limits before research. No actual respondent, quote, budget, commitment, free-rival price, account or spend; no independent learner or overall 10.

Inputs | Two packages and separate freemium

All values stipulated, nonnegative. Counts whole; buyers cannot exceed offers. Paid contribution already net of paid-user variable costs.

A offers	100.00
A buyers	20.00
A price per firm-month	1000.00
A variable cost per paid firm-month	300.00
A acquisition spend	6000.00
B offers	100.00
B buyers	15.00
B price per firm-month	1400.00
B variable cost per paid firm-month	400.00
B acquisition spend	6000.00
Free accounts	1000.00
Cost per free account-month	20.00
Paid accounts	100.00
Contribution per paid account-month	300.00
Fixed monthly operating cost	5000.00

Economics input gate (1=yes)	1.000000

Unit fixed: rupees per firm per month exclusive of tax; no tax rate or actual customer supplied. Zero denominators stay undefined; negative contribution retained. Separate free and paid population not a conversion estimate.

Packages | Contribution after acquisition

Authored hypothetical arithmetic, not real demand, price recommendation, experiment or tax treatment.

A conversion	0.200000
A revenue	20000.000000
A unit contribution	700.000000
A before acquisition	14000.000000
A after acquisition	8000.000000
A net per offer	80.000000
A break-even buyers	8.571429
B conversion	0.150000
B revenue	21000.000000
B unit contribution	1000.000000
B before acquisition	15000.000000
B after acquisition	9000.000000
B net per offer	90.000000
B break-even buyers	6.000000

A baseline: conversion.2, revenue 20000, unit 700, before 14000, after 8000, netoffer 80, break-even 8.571429 buyers. B: .15, 21000, 1000, 15000, 9000, 90, 6. Fractional break-even is a threshold, not a person. No other fixed costs supplied; not accounting profit or causal isolated price effect.

Freemium | A separate monthly model

Authored hypothetical arithmetic, not real demand, price recommendation, experiment or tax treatment.

Total free-account cost	20000.000000
Total paid-account contribution	30000.000000
Net after free cost and fixed cost	5000.000000
Break-even paid accounts, continuous	83.333333
Break-even paid accounts, whole	84.000000
Maximum affordable free accounts, continuous	1250.000000

Baseline 20000, 30000, 5000, 83.333333, 84, 1250. Negative capacity means no nonnegative free-account population is affordable under this model, not negative users. Zero free cost leaves maximum undefined, not zero; zero paid contribution leaves break-even undefined. No retention, churn, conversion or lifetime value estimated.

Perceptions | Six fictional rows, not participants

Four thresholds in rupees per firm-month exclusive of tax. Equal thresholds allowed. Do not substitute three-threshold interview answers or real personal records.

Toy ID	Too cheap	Bargain	Expensive	Too expensive	Valid (1=yes)
Toy 1	200.00	600.00	1000.00	1800.00	1.000000
Toy 2	300.00	700.00	1200.00	2000.00	1.000000
Toy 3	400.00	800.00	1400.00	2200.00	1.000000
Toy 4	500.00	900.00	1600.00	2400.00	1.000000
Toy 5	600.00	1000.00	1800.00	2600.00	1.000000
Toy 6	700.00	1100.00	2000.00	2800.00	1.000000
All six valid?					1.000000

Numeric/nonnegative/order checks only, not respondent eligibility, honesty, comprehension, sampling or population validity. Blocking curves on a bad row is an explicit teaching policy. Preserve raw data and explain exclusions; never force order or fabricate replies.

Curves | Empirical perceptions only

p in rupees per firm-month. Descending curves use threshold>p; ascending use threshold<=p. No inferred willingness to buy or profit optimum.

Grid price p	Too cheap >p	Bargain >p	Expensive <=p	Too expensive <=p
0.00	1.000000	1.000000	0.000000	0.000000
500.00	0.333333	1.000000	0.000000	0.000000
1000.00	0.000000	0.166667	0.166667	0.000000
1500.00	0.000000	0.000000	0.500000	0.000000
2000.00	0.000000	0.000000	1.000000	0.333333
2500.00	0.000000	0.000000	1.000000	0.666667
3000.00	0.000000	0.000000	1.000000	1.000000

Grid valid?	1.000000

At p 1000: too-cheap 0, bargain 1/6, expensive 1/6, too-expensive 0. All 6 equalweight. Exact-boundary convention matters for tiny samples. No continuous interpolation, range/OPP estimate, NMS purchase-intent mapping or actual demand generated. Source chart conventions differ; labels alone cannot settle them.

Research plan | Prepare, do not field

Not an actual survey, research approval, respondent recruitment or current competitor-price comparison.

Unit and context	Specify firm versus seat versus filing, period, taxes, entitlements and eligible buyer role. Check measurable value, predictability, delivery cost and gaming. Forty times clients need not mean forty times value. Unusable decoy tiers and hidden fees are not a substitute for useful fences.
Method choice	Three-threshold interview can explore context; four-question PSM explores perceptions; Gabor-Granger elicits stated purchase intentions; conjoint models choices among attributes. Neither stated intent nor fitted choice is automatically actual purchases. Need behavioral validation and relevant alternatives.
Contradictions visible	Conjointly supports PSM and adaptive Gabor-Granger. MIT 2010 lecture criticizes PSM predictive claims and price-ladder negotiation. Chapman supports exploratory PSM but opposes forcing ordered answers. Different cleaning and chart conventions exist; preserve disagreement instead of manufacturing consensus.
Competitor free bundle	Explicit hypothetical only. Recheck actual buyer alternatives, paid differentiation, service and free-user cost before reacting. No current Zoho/Clear prices verified, no free bundle launched, and no customer or purchase commitment invented.
Transfer check	Close notes: make free cost 40 and explain net-15000; make paid contribution 0 and explain undefined break-even; set one bargain below too-cheap and explain blocked curves; restore raw values. At p 1000 explain strict > versus <=, not elasticity. Actual independent answers blank.
Before field work	Permission-cleared participants and account access, consent, comprehension pilot, eligibility, sampling and no-buy alternatives; predeclare raw-data retention, ordering/equality/cleaning and boundary rules. Review confidentiality and decision/stop limits. No external research or price/account/spend authorized.

Actual plan | Evidence and consent blank

No actual CA, respondent, quote, consent, purchase commitment or accepted owner supplied.

Question	Buyer role	Unit / period	Evidence gap	Consent scope	Owner / acceptance	Stop / review

Write only source-grounded evidence if later authorized. A blank field is unknown, not permission or a fabricated negative response. Nothing sent or collected; no legal/tax opinion, independent learner or overall 10 claim.

Evidence | Written coverage and disagreement

Six URLs/five organizations across vendor, academic, practitioner and accounting sources. Not six independent validation studies; no source figure pixels or podcast AV.

Conjointly PSM	https://conjointly.com/products/van-westendorp/ | Complete returned written main explanation incl four questions, NMS, limitations and alternative chart conventions read. Vendor perspective; NMS approximations are not actual demand. Figures/video not inspected.
Conjointly comparison	https://conjointly.com/blog/gabor-granger-or-van-westendorp/ | Complete returned written 2018/2023 article and FAQs read. Adaptive stated-intent method; blanket zero-value claim for simple WTP not adopted. No underlying lamp/coffee data independently checked.
MIT pricing notes	https://ocw.mit.edu/courses/15-818-pricing-spring-2010/59dd681ca6c787b8a7a5f669974b0f77_MIT15_818S10_lec04.pdf | Selected opening sections 1.1-1.3 read: price awareness versus purchase, context and ladder risks. Strong PSM criticism kept distinct from vendor/practitioner support. Not whole lecture or figures.
Chapman Quant UX	https://quantuxblog.com/intro-to-the-van-westendorp-pricing-exercise | Complete returned written article and R code read. PSM perceptions not WTP; inconsistency diagnostic, no forced order. His implementation differs from this explicit teaching gate. Package not installed or executed; figure pixels not inspected.
HBR value pricing	https://hbr.org/2016/08/a-quick-guide-to-value-based-pricing | Returned title/byline 2016 and opening introductory paragraph only; not fullpublication or operational framework verification. No claims about exact value capture rule derived from excerpt.
OpenStax accounting	https://openstax.org/books/principles-managerial-accounting/pages/3-key-terms | Complete returned chapter 3 keyterms read: unit/total contribution, break-even and relevant range. Supports terms, not real demand or this hypothetical sample validity. No book/podcast/AV or native Excel/Sheetsparity/learner/account/full 10 clearance.

Failure log | Executed authored checks

Only fill after execution. Synthetic perceptions not customer research, behavioral validation or independent learner evidence.

1	PASS: 57 baseline formulas independently recomputed.
2	PASS: 24 changed sets plus restore.
3	PASS: 16 invalid economics/912 isolation checks.
4	PASS: 30 bad perception rows/1710 isolation checks.
5	PASS: 8 invalid grids/456 isolation checks.
6	PASS: equal-threshold boundary/57 checks.
7	PASS: 6 broken references/6 explicit checks.
8	PASS: actual research/consent/owner plan blank.